RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Principal Software Engineer | Backend Systems

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer and engineering leader with 21 years of experience building large-scale services and distributed systems in Python, Go and C++. Technical experience includes API development, high-throughput service design, PostgreSQL and event-driven systems. Led organisations of up to 45 engineers and defined architecture for platforms serving 50M+ users; continue to write code every week, mostly internal tooling in recent years.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform - Streamhaus GmbH (video streaming), Munich *2019 - Aug 2026*

- Led the platform organisation: 5 teams, 45 engineers and 5 engineering managers, responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Drove migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services on GKE; improved playback API availability from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Reduced cloud spend by 31% (EUR 4.2M/year) through rightsizing, committed use discounts and an internal cost dashboard.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Grew the organisation from 18 to 45 engineers and conducted 200+ interviews.

Principal Engineer - Streamhaus GmbH *2015 - 2019*

- Technical lead for the playback API, built with Python, Tornado and later an internal FastAPI-like framework, Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed an entitlement service handling 120k requests/second at peak using Go and Cassandra.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer - Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart *2010 - 2015*

- Developed backend systems for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of 6 developers on the route-history product.

Software Engineer - Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe *2005 - 2010*

- Developed C++ and Python for industrial data acquisition software on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for 8 years.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent MSc) Computer Science, Rhine Valley University, 2005

SKILLS

Python (Django, Flask, FastAPI, Tornado, asyncio), Go, C++ (older); PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ; GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), AWS (EC2, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform; gRPC, Protobuf; Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry; distributed systems design, architecture reviews, technical hiring, people management

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)

PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

- “Running Python at 100k rps” - EuroPython-style conference talk, 2018
- “Cost is a feature” - internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023